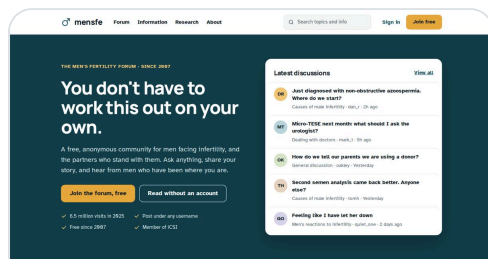


# Four directions for the Mensfe forum

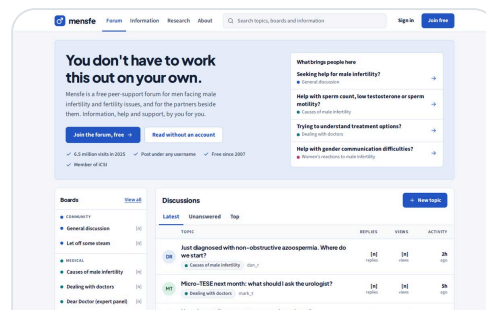
Each direction redesigns the same forum around the same content: a forum-first homepage, the board index, a topic page and a medical information page, all mobile-ready and built to fix the issues in the SEO audit.

Directions A–C present the forum through a modern website front; Direction D keeps the look and feel of a true message board. Please pick one direction (or the parts you like from each) and we will develop it into the full site and SMF theme.



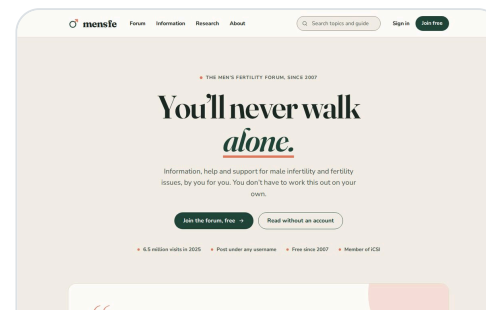
## A • Harbour

Bold and branded. Confident, recognisable, a little dramatic.



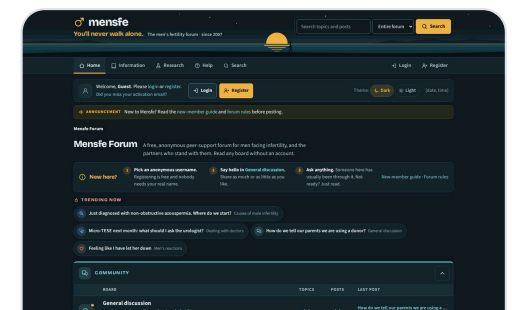
## B • Clear

Clean and clinical. Feels like a modern health service crossed with a forum app.



## C • Stories

Warm and human. Leads with members' voices, like a thoughtful magazine.

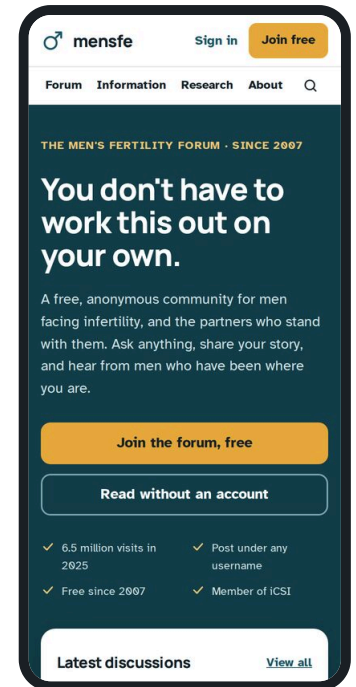
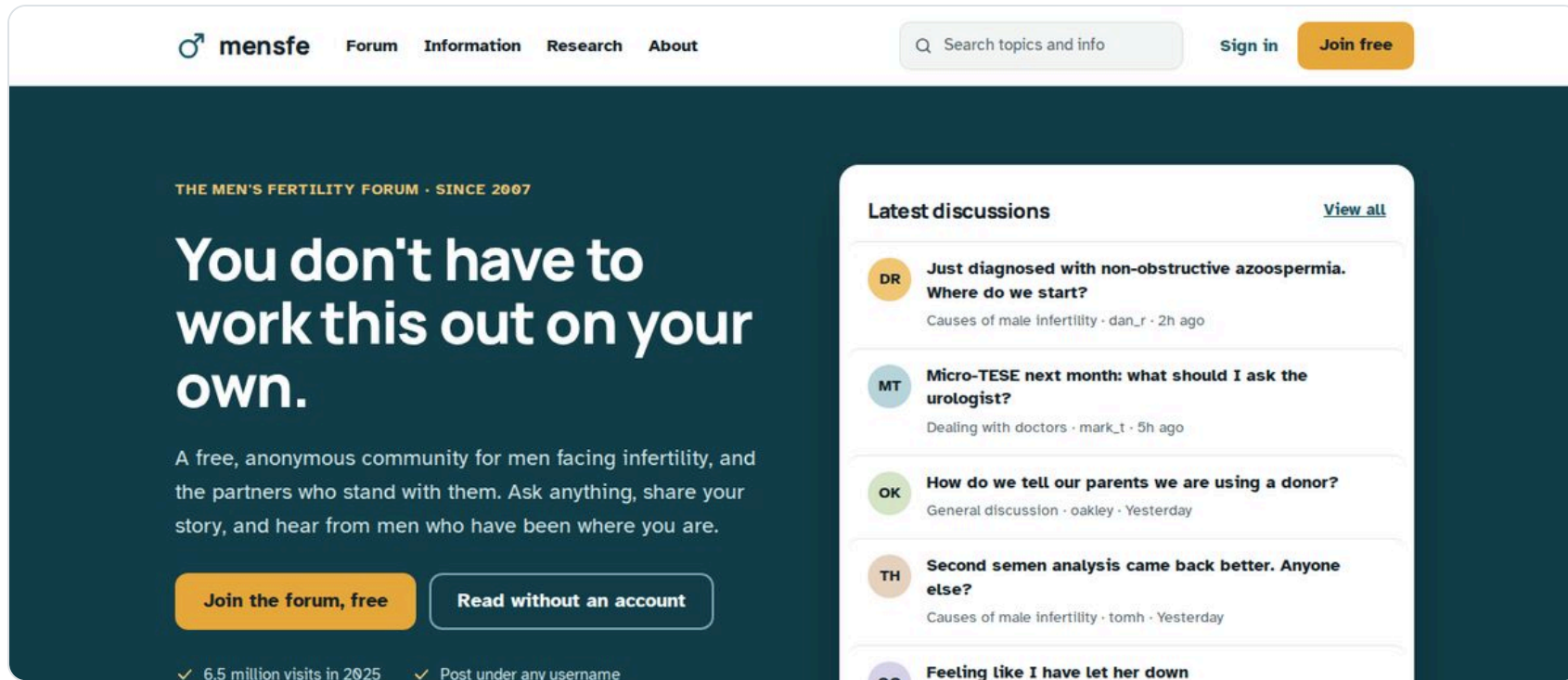


## D • Forum

A true message board. Dark, distinctive and built around the board index.

All three share the same fixes: one clear heading per page, real text instead of text in images, latest discussions on the homepage, the founders' credentials on show, reviewer and date on medical pages, accessible contrast, and layouts that work on phones. Member counts appear as [n] placeholders, and sample posts are illustrative.

# Harbour: bold and branded



## Personality

- The deep sea-teal of the current shoreline banner, with a sunset-gold call to action
- A strong, memorable hero; the forum is visible from the first screen
- Best if Mensfe wants to look established and confident

## Colour and type

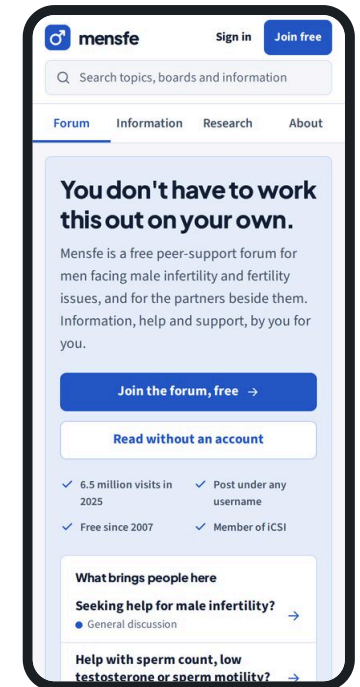
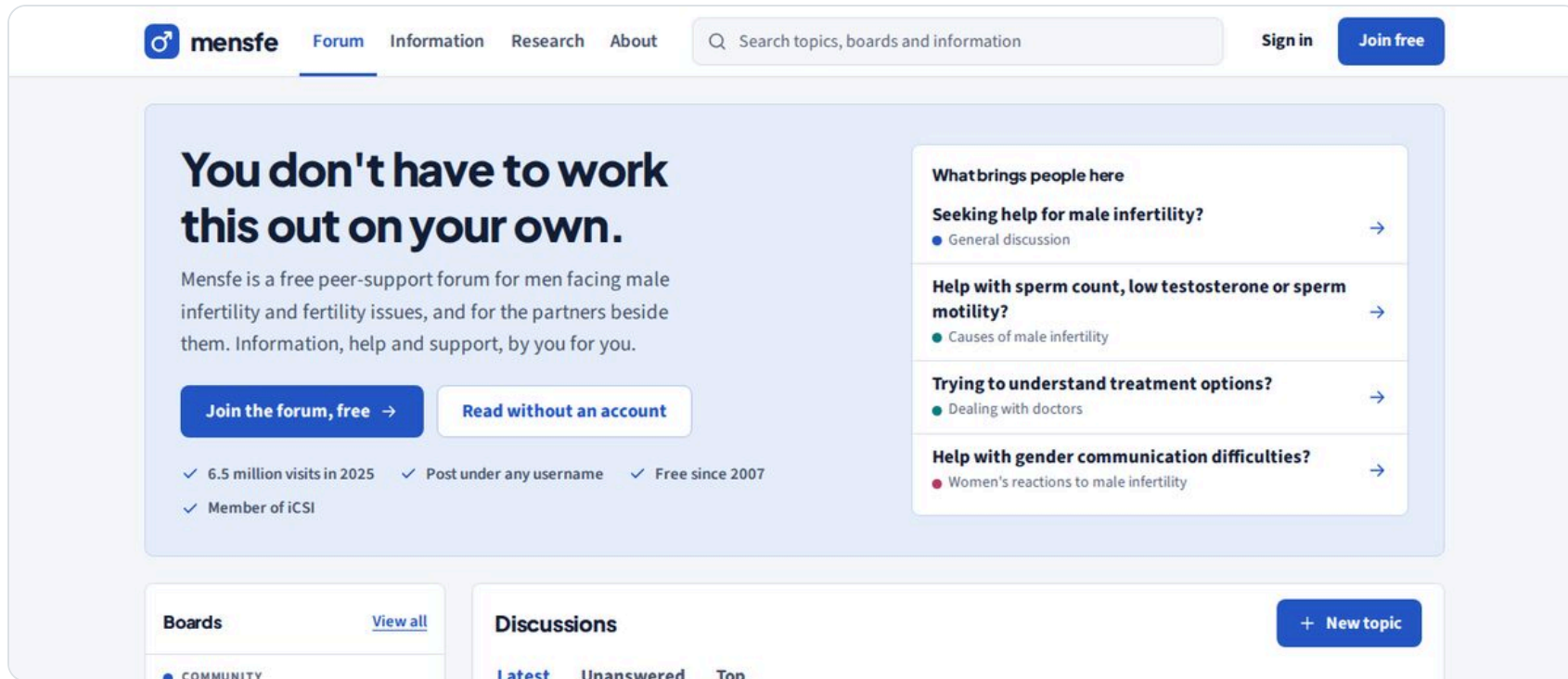


- Manrope headings, Atkinson Hyperlegible body text (designed for low-vision readability)

## Watch-outs

- Dark bands are heavier on long pages
- Gold needs disciplined use to stay special

# Clear: clean and clinical



## Personality

- Calm, trustworthy and information-dense, like a modern health service
- A forum "app" layout: boards in a sidebar, a live topic feed with Latest, Unanswered and Top
- Best if Mensfe wants to feel medically credible and efficient

## Colour and type

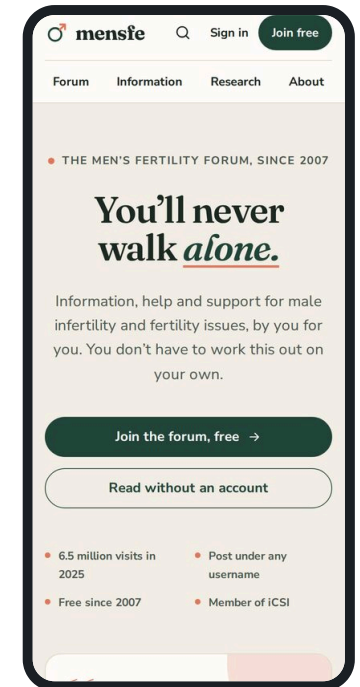
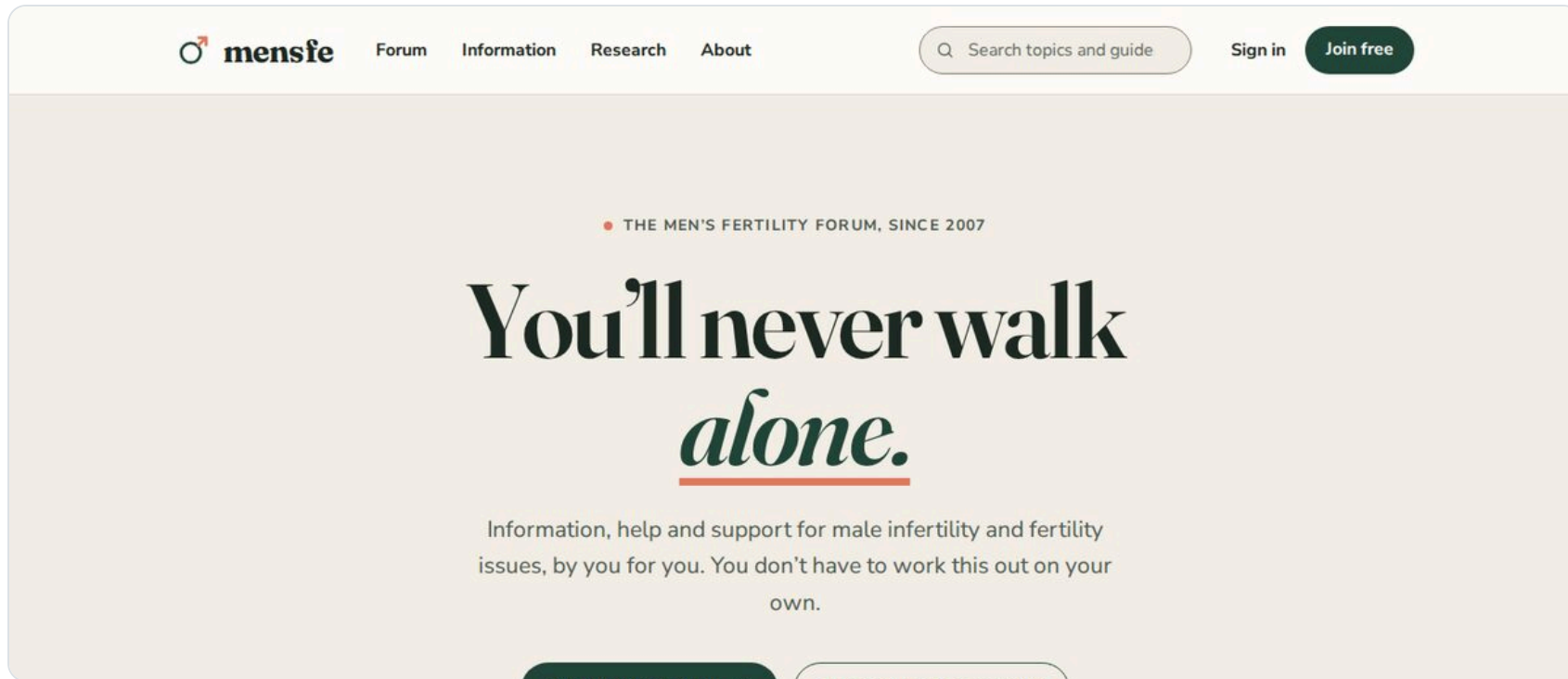


- Plus Jakarta Sans headings, Source Sans 3 body text

## Watch-outs

- Can feel less personal; relies on activity in the feed
- Closest to SMF's own structure, so the easiest to theme

## Stories: warm and human



### Personality

- Editorial and reassuring; members' own words take centre stage
- Generous spacing and a serif voice for a reflective, magazine feel
- Best if Mensfe wants to emphasise empathy and the emotional side

### Colour and type



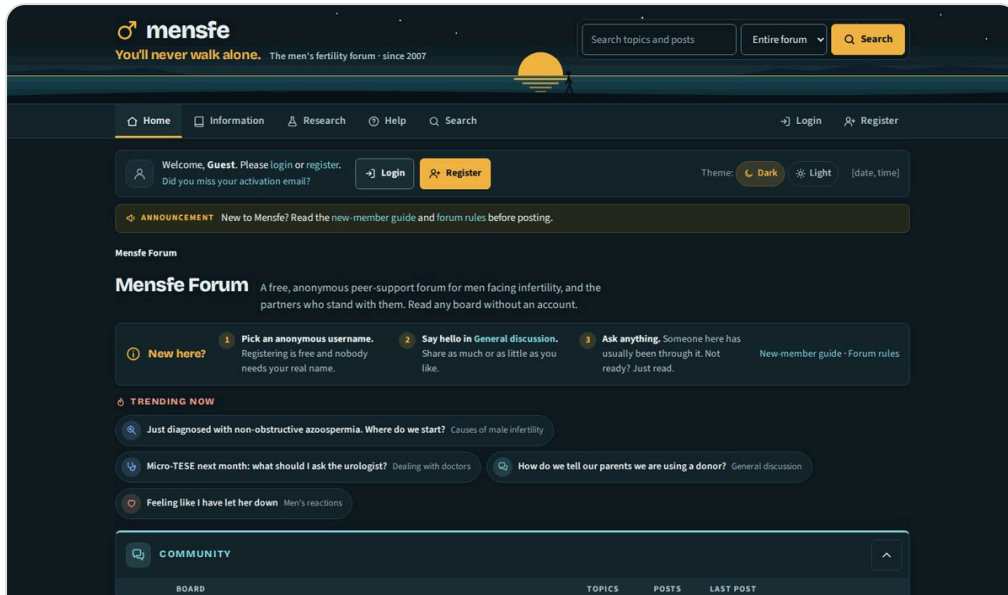
- Fraunces headings, Nunito Sans body text

### Watch-outs

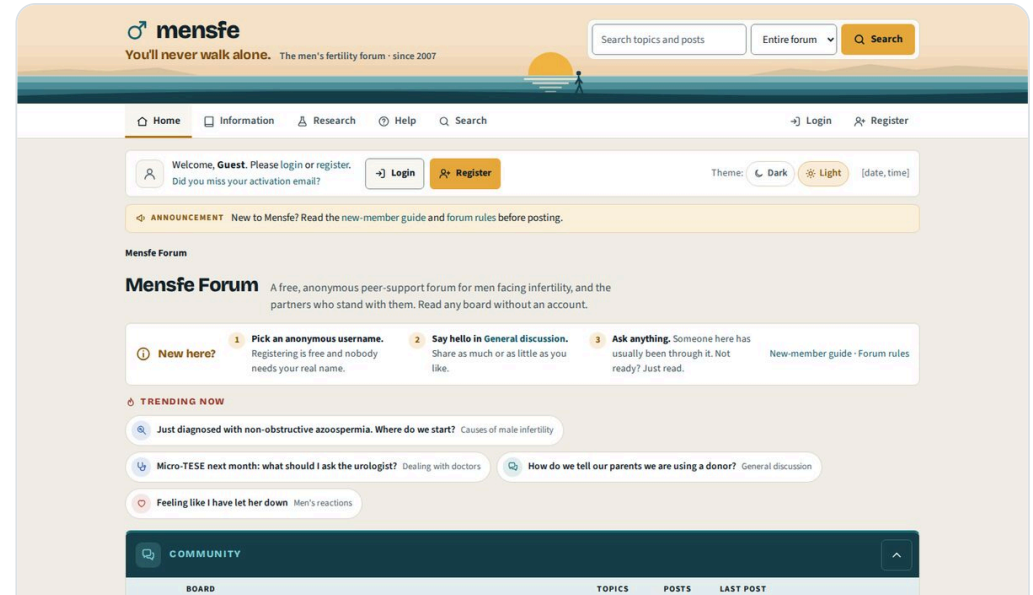
- Needs members' consent for featured stories
- Less dense, so more scrolling on busy boards

## DIRECTION D

# Forum: a true message board, reimagined



Dark · Midnight shoreline



Light · Daybreak shoreline

## Personality

- The board index is the homepage, so regulars land straight in the forum
- Classic forum anatomy (category bars, last-post columns, profile panels beside posts, quick reply, info center) with a modern dark finish
- An illustrated night-shoreline banner revives "You'll never walk alone at Mensfe"

## Colour and type



- Bricolage Grotesque headings, Source Sans 3 body text; each category has its own colour

## Watch-outs

- Comes in dark and light; SMF can offer both as a member setting
- Closest to SMF's own templates, so it is the quickest to build

# How the directions compare

|                     | A · HARBOUR                                     | B · CLEAR                       | C · STORIES                          | D · FORUM                                        |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| First impression    | Confident, branded                              | Professional, efficient         | Warm, empathetic                     | Distinctive, community-first                     |
| Forum emphasis      | Latest-discussions card in the hero; board grid | Live topic feed is the homepage | Featured member stories, then boards | The whole site is the forum; board index is home |
| Medical credibility | Good                                            | Strongest                       | Good, more personal                  | Good (information section inside the forum)      |
| Emotional warmth    | Medium                                          | Lower                           | Highest                              | Medium–high (members' voices up front)           |
| Effort to theme SMF | Medium                                          | Low                             | Medium–high                          | Lowest                                           |
| Accessibility       | Very high (hyperlegible body font)              | High                            | High                                 | High (contrast checked for dark mode)            |

**What happens next:** once a direction is chosen, we design the remaining pages (sign-up, profile, search, private messages and the 12 information guides), build the responsive SMF theme, and implement the SEO and AI visibility fixes from the audits during the same build.

THE MEN'S FERTILITY FORUM, SINCE 2007

# You'll never walk *alone.*

Information, help and support for male infertility and fertility issues, by you for you. You don't have to work this out on your own.

Join the forum, free →

Read without an account

6.5 million visits in 2025 Post under any username Free since 2007 Member of iCSI

“

I was exactly where you are three years ago. Write your questions down before the appointment, because you will forget them in the room.

Ask whether they have checked your karyotype and for Y-chromosome microdeletions, because that changed what our options were.

And look after yourself. The first month was the hardest part for me.

MT

mark\_t, Causes of male infertility board

Member, replying to a newly diagnosed member

FEATURED MEMBER STORY

In reply to

“Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?”

Read the whole conversation →

Every story on Mensfe is shared under a username. Nobody needs to know who you are to be heard.

## Stories from the forum

The latest conversations, in members' own words. Read along, or add your voice when you are ready.

All latest discussions →

Causes of male infertility

**Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?**

Two semen analyses with no sperm found and a high FSH result. Looking for what to ask at the next appointment.

DR

dan\_r · 2h ago

[n]

General discussion

**How do we tell our parents we are using a donor?**

We have decided on donor conception and want to share it with family. How did others start that conversation?

OA

oakley · Yesterday

[n]

Men's reactions to infertility

**Feeling like I have let her down**

Since the diagnosis I keep feeling responsible. Has anyone else felt this way, and what helped?

QO

quiet\_one · 2 days ago

[n]

ALSO NEW Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist? Dealing with doctors · mark\_t · 5h ago

Second semen analysis came back better. Anyone else? Causes of male infertility · tomh · Yesterday

## Whatever brought you here, there's a board for it

Men arrive with all kinds of questions. Someone here has usually asked yours before.

See the full forum →

Seeking help for male infertility?

Low sperm count, low testosterone or motility?

Trying to understand treatment options?

Finding it hard to talk about?

Community

Medical

Feelings and relationships

Research

General discussion

Anything and everything about male fertility.

[n] topics

Causes of male infertility

Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.

[n] topics

Dear Doctor (expert panel)

Questions answered by our medical panel.

[n] topics

Women's reactions to male infertility

Partners share their side.

[n] topics

Let off some steam

Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.

[n] topics

Dealing with doctors

Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.

[n] topics

Men's reactions to infertility

How it feels, from the men living it.

[n] topics

Current research on male infertility

New studies, trials and news.

[n] topics

Browse all boards

Start a new topic

## New here? Start in three small steps

There is no right way to begin. Many members read quietly for weeks before they post, and that is fine too.

@any\_name

Only your username is shown

STEP 1

**Choose an anonymous username**

Join free and pick any name you like. Nobody on the forum needs to know who you are.

Join free →

Hello.

STEP 2

**Say hello**

Introduce yourself in General discussion. Share as much or as little as you like.

Go to General discussion →

?

no question too small

STEP 3

**Ask anything**

Tests, treatment, feelings, relationships. Members who have been there will answer from experience.

Start a topic →

## Plain-language information

Clear guides to the words, tests and choices you will meet, each linked to the boards where men talk them through.

✓ Our information resources are free for everyone

Medical guide

The jargon, explained

Emotive guide

The emotional side of it

Male fertility

Infertility

Semen analysis

Azoospermia

Varicocele

Treatment

Vasectomy reversal

Erection problems

Egg donation

Sperm donation

Nutrition

Counselling support

RESEARCH BOARD

**Current Research On Male Infertility**

Members share and discuss new studies, trials and news, and talk about what it might mean for them. A calm place to make sense of the headlines.

Visit the research board →

New studies and clinical trials, shared and discussed by members

Questions to take to your own clinic or consultant

Mensfe is a member of iCSI and presented a poster at the iCSI 2007 conference

WHO RUNS MENSFE

## Started by people who have been there

Mensfe is run by a fertility counsellor and a man who was told he had azoospermia. Since 2007 it has been a place for men to be honest about something that often goes unspoken.

About us and our mission →

PR

**Pip Reilly**

Co-founder · Fertility counsellor

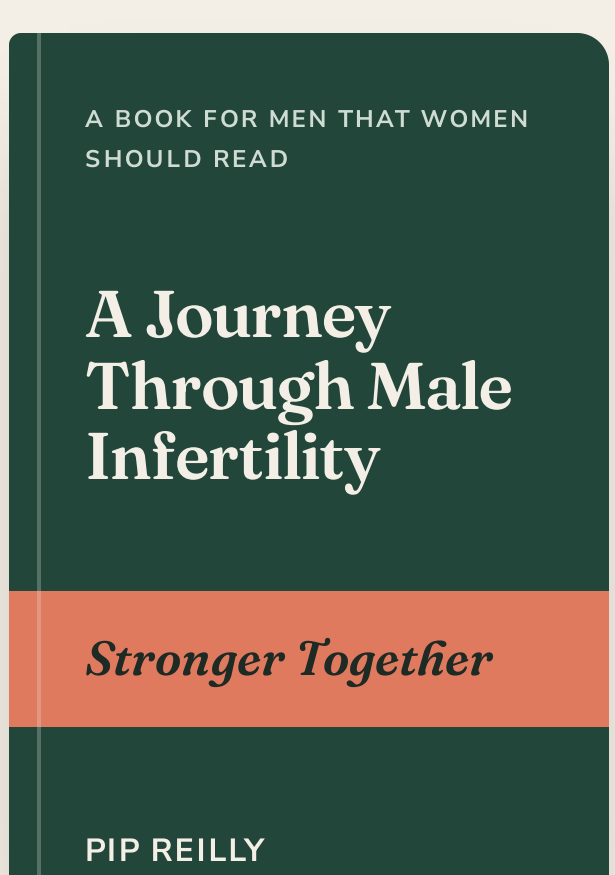
A professional fertility counsellor with over 15 years' experience with fertility charities, and author of *A Journey Through Male Infertility*.

RB

**Rob Barlow**

Co-founder · Medical scientist

A medical scientist who was diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago, and knows first-hand what that news feels like.



THE BOOK

## A Journey Through Male Infertility: Stronger Together

by Pip Reilly, co-founder of Mensfe

*“A book for men that women should read.”*

An honest, accessible account of the relational, emotional and physical challenges men face, often unspoken, with practical support strategies for both partners. You are stronger together.

Buy on Amazon ↗

Peer support, not medical advice. Mensfe is peer support. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice.



[Home](#) › [Forum](#)

# The forum

Eight boards, one community. Find the conversation that fits where you are today, or start your own.

Search the forum

 Try “micro-TESE” or “telling family”

Search

+ Start a new topic

 You can read every board without an account. Join free to post.



## Community

Say hello, talk about anything, let it out.

2 boards



### General discussion

Anything and everything about male fertility.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

How do we tell our parents we are using a donor?

by oakley · Yesterday



### Let off some steam

Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

Another pregnancy announcement at work today

by sam\_k · 3h ago

## Who’s online

[n] members and [n] guests are reading right now.

DR

MT

OA

QO

+

dan\_r, mark\_t, oakley, quiet\_one and [n] others

## New member guide

Three small steps to your first post.

1

Join free and choose an anonymous username.

2

Say hello in General discussion.

3

Ask anything. Someone has been there.

Read the full guide



## Medical

Causes, tests, doctors and treatment.

3 boards



### Causes of male infertility

Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

by dan\_r · 2h ago



### Dealing with doctors

Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

by mark\_t · 5h ago



### Dear Doctor (expert panel)

Questions answered by our medical panel.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

Does a high FSH result change what retrieval can find?

by ali\_h · 3 days ago

Expert answers



## Feelings and relationships

How infertility feels, for men and for the people beside them.

2 boards



### Men’s reactions to infertility

How it feels, from the men living it.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

Feeling like I have let her down

by quiet\_one · 2 days ago



### Women’s reactions to male infertility

Partners share their side.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

How do I support him when he doesn’t want to talk?

by jo\_partner · 4 days ago



## Research

What is new in the science, discussed calmly.

1 board



### Current research on male infertility

New studies, trials and news.

[n] topics

[n] posts

LAST POST

Has anyone read the latest paper on micro-TESE?

by tomh · 1 week ago

## Forum rules

1

Be kind. Everyone here is going through something.

2

Protect your privacy and other people’s.

3

Share experience, not medical instructions.

4

No advertising or promotion of clinics or products.

Read all forum rules →

## Need to talk to someone?

Mensfe is peer support. Our Counselling Support page lists services if you would like professional help.

Counselling support

Causes of male infertility

# Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

Started by **dan\_r**

2h ago

[n] replies

[n] views

Reply

Follow

Share

DR

**dan\_r**

Member

Original post

Joined [date] · [n] posts

2h ago

My wife and I got the results last week. Two semen analyses, both showed no sperm at all, and the consultant thinks it is probably non-obstructive. My FSH came back high.

I honestly don't know what to feel. I keep reading about micro-TESE and success rates and it is all a blur. If anyone has been through this, what should we be asking at the next appointment?

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

Topic info

Board

[Causes of male infertility](#)

Started

2h ago

Replies

[n]

Following

[n]

Related information

Azoospermia explained

→

Surgical sperm retrieval

→

Counselling support

→

## Replies

[n] so far

MT

**mark\_t**

Member

Joined [date] · [n] posts

1h ago

I was exactly where you are three years ago. Write your questions down before the appointment, because you will forget them in the room. Ask whether they have checked your karyotype and for Y-chromosome microdeletions, because that changed what our options were.

And look after yourself. The first month was the hardest part for me.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply



**Mensfe Team**

Moderator

Joined [date] · [n] posts

45m ago

Welcome, and thank you for posting. A lot of men read this board without ever writing, so this will help others too. Our [Azoospermia guide](#) explains the tests and treatment terms you will hear, and the [Counselling Support page](#) lists services if you would like to talk to someone.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

JP

**jo\_partner**

Partner

Joined [date] · [n] posts

20m ago

Wife of a member here. It is not your fault, and she is probably as worried about you as about the result. Talking to each other helped us more than anything the clinic said.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

Add your voice

A few kind words can mean a lot to someone who has just had this news. Share what helped you, or simply let dan\_r know he is not alone.

Your reply

B

I

🔗

“

Write as you would to a friend. You can post under any username.

☒ Notify me of replies

Post reply →

You will need to [sign in](#) or [join free](#) to post. Reading is always free.

ⓘ

A gentle note

This is peer support, not medical advice. Members share their own experience; please talk decisions through with your doctor.

Similar topics

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

Dealing with doctors · [n] replies

Waiting for genetic test results

Causes of male infertility · [n] replies

Obstructive after vasectomy: reversal or retrieval?

Causes of male infertility · [n] replies

 mensfe

You don't have to work this out on your own.

Information, help and support for male infertility and fertility issues, by you for you. Our information resources are free for everyone.

info@mensfe.net

FORUM

All boards

Latest discussions

General discussion

Dear Doctor (expert panel)

Forum rules

INFORMATION

Azoospermia

Semen analysis

Treatment

Counselling support

Medical guide

Emotive guide

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iCSI membership

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# Azoospermia

Azoospermia means there is no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It is hard news to hear, but it has known causes, clear tests and more than one possible route forward. This guide explains it in plain language.

 WRITTEN BY  
[Author name]

 MEDICALLY REVIEWED BY  
[Reviewer name, credentials]

 LAST REVIEWED  
[Last reviewed date]

Mensfe is run by Pip Reilly, a professional fertility counsellor with over 15 years' experience with fertility charities, and Rob Barlow, a medical scientist who was diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago. [About us](#)

## ON THIS PAGE

- 01 What is azoospermia?
- 02 The two main types
- 03 How it is diagnosed
- 04 Treatment options
- 05 You are not alone
- 06 Sources

Have a question this page doesn't answer?

06 Ask the community

### In short

- ✓

Azoospermia means no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It is usually confirmed by at least two semen analyses.
- ✓

It affects about 1% of all men and around 10–15% of men with infertility.
- ✓

There are two main types: obstructive (sperm are made but blocked) and non-obstructive (the testes make very little or no sperm).
- ✓

Depending on the cause, options include surgical repair, sperm retrieval used with ICSI, hormone treatment for some men, or donor sperm.

## What is azoospermia?

Azoospermia is the medical term for having no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. Many men only find out when they have a semen analysis as part of fertility tests.

1% of all men are affected by azoospermia.  
That rises to around 10–15% of men with infertility.

A single result is not enough for a diagnosis. Azoospermia is usually confirmed by at least two semen analyses, with the sample spun down (centrifuged) so the laboratory can look carefully for any sperm at all.

## The two main types

Doctors divide azoospermia into two groups, because the cause shapes which treatments make sense.

### OBSTRUCTIVE

#### Sperm are made, but blocked

The testes produce sperm, but a blockage stops them reaching the ejaculate.

Causes include a previous vasectomy, infection or injury, or congenital absence of the vas deferens, which is linked to cystic fibrosis gene changes.

### NON-OBSTRUCTIVE

#### Very little or no sperm made

The testes make very little or no sperm.

Causes include genetic conditions such as Klinefelter syndrome or Y-chromosome microdeletions, hormone problems, a history of undescended testes, or previous chemotherapy or radiotherapy.

“  
*Write your questions down before the appointment, because you will forget them in the room.*”

mark\_t, on the [Causes of male infertility board](#)

## How it is diagnosed

Working out the type and cause usually involves several steps. Your doctor may suggest some or all of these:



#### Repeat semen analysis

At least two samples, centrifuged and examined.



#### Physical examination

Including the testes and the vas deferens.



#### Hormone blood tests

FSH, LH and testosterone.



#### Genetic tests

Karyotype, Y-chromosome microdeletion and CFTR.



#### Scrotal ultrasound

Sometimes, to look at the testes and surrounding structures.



### Questions you might take to your appointment

- Do you think my azoospermia is obstructive or non-obstructive, and why?
- Which hormone tests have been done, and what did they show?
- Have I had a karyotype, Y-chromosome microdeletion and CFTR test?
- Would a scrotal ultrasound help in my case?

## Treatment options

The right option depends on the type and cause. These are the main routes you are likely to hear about.

### OBSTRUCTIVE

#### Repair or retrieve

Surgical repair of the blockage, such as vasectomy reversal.

Or sperm retrieval (PESA, MESA or TESA), with the sperm used in ICSI.

### NON-OBSTRUCTIVE

#### Hormones or micro-TESE

In some men, hormone treatment.

Surgical sperm retrieval such as micro-TESE, with any sperm found used in ICSI.

Donor sperm is another route to parenthood, and some couples consider it alongside or after other options.

Every situation is different. Talk your options through with a urologist or andrologist, who can explain what is realistic for you.

### FROM THE FORUM

## You are not alone

[n] members are discussing azoospermia on the Causes of male infertility board. Read their stories, or ask your own question under any username.

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

dan\_r · 2h ago

Waiting for genetic test results

[n] replies

Obstructive after vasectomy: reversal or retrieval?

[n] replies

Visit the board →

Ask the community

## Sources

1. [Source 1 — e.g. NHS / NICE / WHO guidance]
2. [Source 2 — e.g. professional society guideline on male infertility]
3. [Source 3 — e.g. peer-reviewed review article]



**Disclaimer.** Mensfe is peer support. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice. Always discuss your own results and options with a qualified clinician.

Was this page helpful?

✓ Yes

✗ No

### Related information

Semen analysis

Treatment

Vasectomy reversal

Sperm donation

Counselling support